TenSyGrid

TenSyGrid toolbox: Use case identification and description

Project: Tensors for system analysis of converter-dominated power grids

Deliverable report D4.1

Public

Reporter
Alexandre Gràcia Calvo
Carlos Herrera Vázquez
Prof. Eduardo Prieto Araujo

Project coordinator
Dr. Carlos Cateriano Yáñez

31 October 2026
Barcelona

Universitat Politècnica de Catalunya, UPC
Address:
Carrer Jordi Girona 31, 08034 Barcelona

Due Date 30/11/2026
www.upc.edu

TenSyGrid toolbox: Use case identification and description
Project: Tensors for system analysis of converter-dominated power grids

Deliverable report D4.1

Leading Partner	Universitat Politècnica de Catalunya - BarcelonaTech
Call Management	CETPartnership
Due Date	30/11/2026
Deliverable Responsible	Universitat Politècnica de Catalunya
Project No.	CETP-FP-2023-00138
Work Package	WP 4
Classification	Public
Version	v1.1.0

Reporter

Eduardo Prieto-Araujo
Principal Investigator and Full Professor at UPC
Alexandre Gràcia Calvo
PhD Student
Carlos Herrera Vázquez
PhD Student

Project coordinator

Dr. Carlos Cateriano Yáñez
Project coordinator

Reviewer

Dr. John Licari
Principal Investigator at UM

Acknowledgement

This research was funded by CETPartnership, the Clean Energy Transition Partnership under the 2023 joint call for research proposals, co funded by the European Commission (GA 101 069750) and with the funding organizations detailed on https://cetpartnership.eu/funding-agencies-and-call-modules.





Co-funded by
the European Union

Supported by:



on the basis of a decision
by the German Bundestag









About TenSyGrid

The demand for the power grid in Europe is undergoing profound changes due to an increasing number of decentralized feed-in points and the fluctuating supply from renewable energies. This complexity in interactions between power grid components poses a challenge for maintaining system stability. To address this, the European project TenSyGrid is developing a toolbox for direct stability assessment using multilinear models to capture the complex dynamics of power grid components. The objective is to support grid operators in assessing large power grids primarily powered by renewable energy. The toolbox will be compatible with existing commercial software packages to facilitate integration into current workflows.

Project coordinator:

Fraunhofer IWES

Consortium:

Fraunhofer IWES

CITCEA UPC

eRoots
Powering Grid Decisions

HAW HAMBURG

L-Università ta' Malta

Summary

This deliverable identifies and describes the use cases that the TenSyGrid Toolbox is expected to support for assessing the stability of converter-dominated power grids. Fourteen use cases are catalogued and organised into two groups: five use cases already prototyped in an initial web-based Stability Monitor and nine additional use cases proposed on the basis of project objectives, existing-tool experience, internal technical discussions, and interviews with industry stakeholders.

The use cases that are already implemented in an experimental way cover the core stability-analysis workflow: launching a small-signal eigenvalue computation, inspecting the system current status via a dashboard, exploring the eigenvalue spectrum, diagnosing critical oscillation modes through participation factors, verifying bus voltage profiles, and performing $N-1$ contingency analysis with some recommendations.

Contents

List of figures

List of tables

1 Introduction

The transition towards converter-dominated power systems, driven by the massive integration of renewable energy sources, is fundamentally altering the dynamic behaviour of electrical grids. As synchronous generation is progressively displaced by inverter-based resources, new stability challenges emerge: reduced system inertia, faster electromagnetic transients, and complex interactions between converter controls and the network. In this context, transmission system operators require tools that can assess stability rapidly, reliably, and under a wide range of operating scenarios.

The European project *TenSyGrid* addresses this need by developing a toolbox for direct stability assessment based on a tensor (multilinear) reformulation of power system component models. By expressing the nonlinear dynamics of generators, converters, lines, loads, and transformers in a multilinear form, the toolbox enables efficient computation of the system's state matrix and its eigenvalues, which are the fundamental indicators of small-signal stability. The toolbox is designed to be compatible with existing commercial software packages, facilitating its integration into current operator workflows.

This deliverable (D4.1) constitutes the first step in Work Package 4 (*TenSyGrid Toolbox Development*). Its objective is to identify, describe, and catalogue the use cases that the toolbox should support, taking network operators, planning engineers, stability analysts, and converter specialists as its principal user profiles. The use cases are derived from four complementary sources:

1. The TenSyGrid project objectives, as defined in the CETPartnership proposal.

2. A review of existing stability-analysis tools and the research group's experience with them.

3. An initial web-based *Stability Monitor* prototype and the technical feedback gathered from the research group while developing it.

4. Semi-structured interviews with industry stakeholders, including transmission-system, consulting, and equipment-manufacturing perspectives.

The document is structured as follows. Chapter 2 describes the methodological approach, the evolution of the software architecture towards a native open-source Python framework, and the insights gathered from industry interviews. Chapter 3 presents the use case inventory, organised into implemented and proposed use cases, and outlines the organisation of the toolbox interface. Each use case is described in terms of its actor, objective, theoretical basis, interaction flow, and expected outcome. The chapter also records candidate workflows that fall outside the current implementation scope and explains why they have not been prioritised. Chapter 4 summarises the conclusions and identifies the next development steps to be agreed within the consortium.

The intended audience for this deliverable includes the TenSyGrid consortium partners, the CETPartnership review bodies, and the industrial partners and stakeholders who will ultimately use and benefit from the toolbox.

2 Methodology and tool architecture

2.1 Methodology

The identification of use cases for the *TenSyGrid* Toolbox follows a user-centred design approach and considers the different roles involved in stability studies. The catalogue was derived from four complementary sources:

1. **Project objectives.** The TenSyGrid proposal defines the toolbox as a stability-assessment platform for converter-dominated power grids. Its core workflow consists of loading a grid model, running a small-signal stability analysis, and interpreting the results.

2. **Review of existing tools.** The research group's experience with established stability-analysis software was used to identify recurring study tasks, expected outputs, and limitations that a new toolbox should address.

3. **Prototype and internal technical feedback.** An initial web-based Stability Monitor implements five core interaction flows: analysis execution (UC-01), system-status monitoring and eigenvalue analysis (UC-02), critical-mode inspection (UC-03), bus-voltage evaluation (UC-04), and $N-1$ contingency assessment (UC-05). Feedback gathered while developing the prototype was used to formalise these implemented use cases and identify candidate extensions.

4. **Industry interviews.** Semi-structured interviews with transmission-system, consulting, and equipment-manufacturing stakeholders were used to validate the relevance of the implemented workflows and formulate additional needs. These needs informed the proposed use cases UC-06 to UC-14, including scenario comparison, trend monitoring, device attribution, and advanced nonlinear assessment.

Each use case is described following a structured template that includes **identifier** and **name**, **actor**, **objective**, **preconditions**, **theoretical basis**, **possible bottlenecks**, **main flow**, **GUI interaction**, and **expected result**.

The toolbox interface follows Shneiderman's visual-information-seeking approach: *overview first, zoom and filter, then details on demand* [1]. In practical terms, the user can:

1. obtain an overview of the system status and its principal stability indicators;
2. zoom into critical modes and regions of the eigenvalue spectrum;
3. filter and sort the results to focus on the most relevant dynamics; and
4. request details on demand, including modal metrics, participation factors, and the physical devices associated with each mode.

This interaction sequence supports both rapid operational screening and deeper technical diagnosis. Once the relevant modes and devices have been identified, the resulting evidence can be used in subsequent use cases to formulate recommendations for controller retuning, contingency mitigation, or further studies.

2.2 Tool scheme and structure

2.2.1 Initial tool scheme and architectural evolution

Initial conceptual scheme (Figure ??). At the outset of the TenSyGrid project, the preliminary architectural roadmap considered MATLAB as a key foundation of the development platform. This initial strategy was primarily motivated by the pre-existing research legacy within the consortium, specifically the Multilinear Time-Invariant (MTI) Toolbox developed in earlier and concurrent project stages [2, 3], alongside the STAMP simulation framework. In this early phase, before key design decisions regarding runtime dependencies were finalized, the toolbox was conceived as a hybrid, multi-branch framework connecting open-source components with existing MATLAB prototypes through dedicated runtime adapters.

This initial conceptual architecture is illustrated in Figure **??**. As originally planned, the platform established two parallel simulation branches:

1. **VeraGrid Platform (Python):** Designed as an open-source modeling environment incorporating modular calculation engines for power flow (VG_{PF}), dynamic root-mean-square

transient simulations (VG_{RMS}), small-signal stability analysis (VG_{SSig}), and a dedicated multilinear/tensor integration layer (VG_{MTI}).

2. **STAMP and MTI Framework (MATLAB):** Encapsulating the original MTI tensor formulation and STAMP power-flow (S_{PF}), electromagnetic transient (S_{EMT}), and small-signal (S_{SSig}) routines, intended to interact with Python via bi-directional process adapters.

3. **Interoperability Layer (IPSA):** Envisioned to ingest network topologies and dynamic controller parameters from external industry-standard tools (PSCAD, DIgSILENT PowerFactory, PSS/E, MATLAB/Simulink).

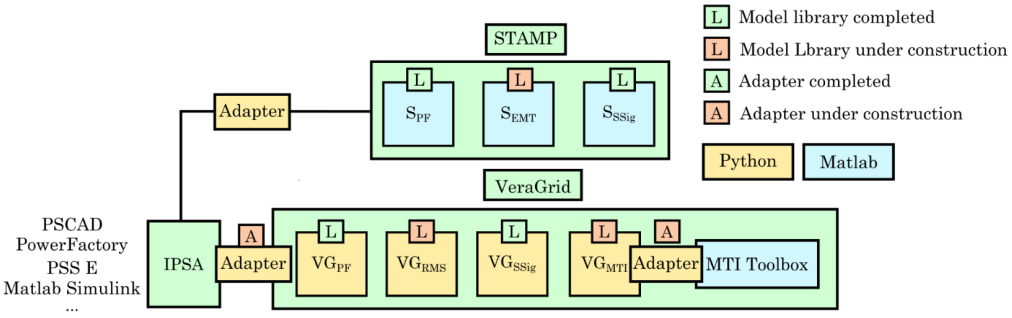


Figure 2.1: Initial conceptual scheme of the TenSyGrid toolbox, conceived during early project stages to explore multi-environment integration. In this preliminary design, external models fed into VeraGrid (Python) while relying on runtime adapters to bridge into MATLAB-based research prototypes for the MTI formulation and STAMP routines.

Strategic architectural consolidation within VeraGrid. While this initial hybrid layout enabled rapid early prototyping by leveraging existing research codebases, detailed evaluation during the architectural definition phase showed that maintaining multiple distinct software packages and heterogeneous runtimes introduced significant operational and maintenance complexity. To establish a production-grade, highly cohesive toolbox for Transmission System Operators (TSOs), the consortium identified substantial advantages in consolidating the entire calculation pipeline into a unified, native Python framework centered around VeraGrid:

- **Single-Stack Architectural Simplicity and Cohesion:** Interfacing separate runtimes across language boundaries required dedicated inter-process communication (IPC) bridges, serialization adapters, and dual-environment management. Consolidating the core multilinear routines natively within VeraGrid's architecture removes multi-package glue code, eliminates data marshaling overhead, and ensures unified memory structures directly shared

between the power flow, descriptor assembly, and eigenvalue solvers.

- **Direct VeraGrid Integration and Codebase Maintainability:** Embedding the multilinear formulation directly into the `VeraGridEngine` ecosystem leverages VeraGrid's native high-performance data model and compiled extensions (Python). This streamlines continuous integration, simplifies testing, and provides a single, uniform API for developers, researchers, and operators alike.

- **Automated Batch Studies:** A unified Python and VeraGrid environment supports repeated studies, such as $N-1$ contingency evaluations and parameter sweeps, through a common codebase. This reduces configuration and maintenance effort across the analysis workflow.

- **Open-Source Accessibility and Reproducibility:** A primary pillar of the European CETPartnership initiative is the creation of openly accessible, transparent, and easily reproducible tools for the broader power systems community. Delivering a fully open-source Python codebase enables TSOs, research institutions, and industry stakeholders to readily inspect, customize, and extend the algorithms without prerequisite software barriers.

- **Seamless Web and Modern Service Coupling:** Python's extensive ecosystem natively bridges scientific computing libraries (NumPy, SciPy, optimized sparse solvers) with modern asynchronous web frameworks (such as FastAPI). This architecture enables high-throughput data streaming to the operator-facing browser interface with minimal overhead.

Consequently, the consortium agreed to consolidate the computational core natively within Python and VeraGrid. The multilinear algorithms and tensor formulations of the MTI framework were re-engineered directly into the dedicated `TensyGridEngine`, running seamlessly as an integrated calculation layer built directly on top of `VeraGridEngine`.

2.2.2 Integrated tool architecture and operational workflow

Following this architectural consolidation, the multi-branch concept of Figure **??** evolved into the streamlined, end-to-end computational and visualization pipeline shown in Figure **??**. This unified architecture eliminates multi-runtime bridges and provides a clean, four-stage data flow from external model ingestion to the operator interface:

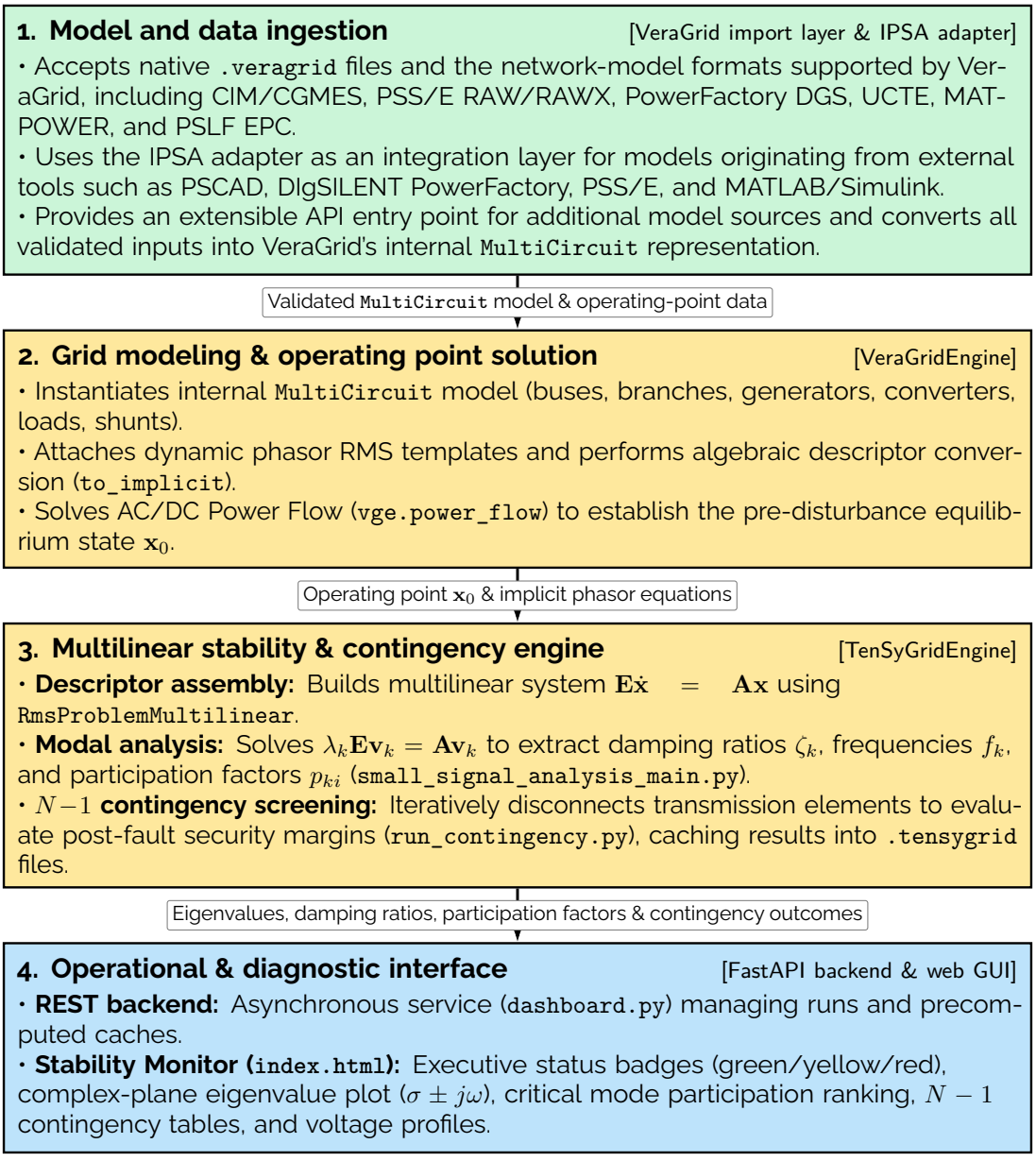


Figure 2.2: Final integrated architecture and computational workflow of the TenSyGrid toolbox, adopted following the architectural consolidation from the initial hybrid multi-language concept into a unified, native open-source Python/VeraGrid environment. The four-stage pipeline spans external model ingestion, VeraGrid modeling, native TenSyGrid multilinear stability analysis, and the operator web interface.

All downstream analyses operate on VeraGrid's internal `MultiCircuit` representation and are therefore independent of the original input channel. A model may be loaded directly from any format supported by VeraGrid, obtained through the IPSA integration layer from tools such as PSCAD, DIgSILENT PowerFactory, PSS/E, or MATLAB/Simulink, or supplied through a configured API endpoint. In every case, the input must provide the topology, equipment parameters, operating point, and dynamic-model information required by the selected analysis and must pass the same conversion and validation process before execution.

The modular decoupling illustrated in Figure **??** ensures clear separation of concerns across the pipeline:

1. **Ingestion and standardisation:** Downstream computational modules remain completely agnostic to the proprietary origins of the network models, relying exclusively on standard internal interfaces.

2. **High-performance core computing:** Heavy numerical operations (power flow, descriptor matrix assembly, generalized eigenvalue solves, and batch contingency runs) run natively in optimized Python libraries on dedicated servers or HPC compute nodes.

3. **Browser-based operator access:** Transmission operators access results through an intuitive, lightweight web browser interface without needing local numerical software or specialized compiler toolchains installed on control-room workstations.

2.3 Operator interviews

To ground the use-case catalogue in real operational practice, three semi-structured interviews were conducted with transmission-system stakeholders; the key findings that shaped the use cases are summarised below.

Former TSO planner and control-room analyst in South America. The interview described an operational workflow based on economic dispatch coordinated in 8-hour shifts, system validation every 15–30 minutes, and $N-1$ contingency screening complemented by short-circuit and RMS dynamic simulations for critical cases. On the planning side, detailed modelling of low-voltage networks and IBRs (including protection systems) overloaded the state-space representation, making small-signal studies (SSTI, SSSI, SSOS) take 3–4 hours. Key operational metrics were the frequency nadir, ROCOF, and the settling time T_{1090}; in

planning, eigenvalue position, damping, SCR variation, and participation factors were used to avoid out-of-band interactions. Regarding the GUI prototype, the interviewee recommended: (i) simplifying status indicators while keeping colour coding in the complex plane; (ii) providing explicit error diagnostics when an analysis fails; (iii) linking eigenvalues and participation factors to specific devices and state variables (ω) to distinguish local from inter-area oscillations; (iv) adding visualisation of operational bands (P-V curves); and (v) supporting sequential contingencies (chains of events, N-2) and multiple simultaneous contingency selection (e.g. via YAML configuration).

HVDC project leader at an equipment manufacturer. The interview outlined three families of studies performed in the HVDC context: (i) *dynamic performance* of an HVDC link under grid events, run in EMT with hundreds of PSCAD cases over 1-2 days; (ii) *RMS* whole-country contingency screening (N-1) on AC networks of the order of 500 km radius (e.g. the UK transmission network), taking a few hours; and (iii) *screening studies* to identify synchronous generators that may interact problematically with the HVDC, run as load-flow and short-circuit analyses in minutes. Small-signal studies are currently performed through impedance scanning (SS-SFI), with the frequency response obtained from PSCAD; clients are beginning to request state-space models (grey-box, per subsystem) for which a Laplace transfer function may be delivered instead, keeping the full model confidential for security reasons. The interview also highlighted harmonic-stability assessment based on gain/phase margins rather than eigenvalues, the need to study voltage collapse in weak grids, and the value of automating time-domain study campaigns and result post-processing.

European mainland TSO specialist. The interview described long-term grid development, short-term planning, and operational processes from week-ahead down to intraday and real-time operation (SCADA/EMS with state estimation). Models are exchanged in CGMES; PowerFactory, PSCAD, and SCADA are the three main software tools. Dynamic security assessment (DSA) involves thousands of contingency cases; computation time limits model detail, and the trade-off is managed by increasing the number of cores. Day-ahead studies use RMS models, while close-to-real-time studies run about 100 cases with reduced detail. Outage management is not automatic, and there is interest in decision-support tools for judging criticality. Regarding HVDC, the interviewee noted the move from Thevenin equivalents towards reduced models and stressed that any deployed tool must integrate with the existing commercial software stack. The completeness of CGMES for dynamic data and the value of software-independent EMT models were also discussed, with VeraGrid identified as a relevant integration platform.

The evidence from the interviews was separated into validation of existing work and requirements for further development:

- **Implemented workflows validated by the interviews.** The stakeholders confirmed the relevance of loading representative operating points (UC-01), inspecting eigenvalues and damping (UC-02), linking critical modes to state variables and physical devices (UC-03), checking operating-point quantities (UC-04), and screening $N-1$ contingencies (UC-05). They also identified improvements required in these workflows, notably clearer error diagnostics, device-level attribution, operational bands, and support for multiple or sequential contingencies.

- **Additional requirements identified through the interviews.** Scenario comparison and stability-margin tracking motivated UC-06 and UC-08; device attribution and systematic contingency ranking motivated UC-07 and UC-09; actionable mitigation guidance motivated UC-10; converter-penetration studies motivated UC-11; and repeatable documentation motivated UC-12. The weak-grid and large-disturbance questions provided additional motivation for the research-oriented UC-13 and UC-14.

The interviews therefore validate the direction of the five implemented use cases while providing evidence for, rather than a commitment to implement, the nine proposed extensions.

3 Use cases

The computational core of the use-case catalogue is the implicit Multilinear Time-Invariant (iMTI) and tensor formulation developed within the TenSyGrid project [2, 3]. Originally researched and prototyped as a dedicated MTI Toolbox in MATLAB, its algorithms and tensor routines have been ported to Python and integrated into the open-source VeraGrid platform as the `TenSyGridEngine`.

The formulation represents the time-invariant component models in multilinear form [4]. The complete system of equations is then transformed following [2, 3] into a tensor representation whose contractions can accelerate Jacobian-matrix computation [5].

The dependency on this engine differs by use case. UC-01, UC-02, UC-03, and UC-05 directly consume iMTI-based eigenvalues, eigenvectors, participation factors, or repeated post-contingency linearisations. UC-04 is a complementary power-flow voltage check included to keep the operating-point assessment coherent, but it is not itself an iMTI calculation. The proposed analytical use cases build on the same engine to different degrees, whereas UC-12 packages results produced by the other use cases into a report. These distinctions are made explicit in the descriptions and workflow maps below.

3.1 Use case inventory

Table **??** summarises the fourteen identified use cases by implementation status. The first five have been prototyped in the Stability Monitor GUI; the remaining nine are candidates for consortium prioritisation according to technical feasibility and expected value for industry and the wider community.

Among the proposed use cases, UC-13 and UC-14 are particularly research-oriented: they go beyond conventional small-signal analysis and may exploit the higher-order capabilities of the iMTI formulation described in [2].

Table 3.1: Use case inventory for the TenSyGrid Toolbox.

ID	Name	Status	Objective
UC-01	Assessment of small-signal stability under given operating conditions	Implemented	Execute a stability computation on a grid model
UC-02	Monitoring and screening of power system small-signal stability margins	Implemented	Obtain an at-a-glance stability classification and explore the eigenvalue distribution
UC-03	Identification and diagnosis of critical oscillatory modes	Implemented	Identify low-damped modes and their physical origin
UC-04	Assessment of bus voltage profiles and operating limit violations	Implemented	Verify voltage profile from the power-flow solution
UC-05	Identification of stability risks under $N-1$ contingencies	Implemented	Evaluate stability impact of single-element outages
UC-06	Comparative stability assessment across operating scenarios	Proposed	Compare stability between two grid snapshots
UC-07	Identification of devices contributing to stability issues	Proposed	Rank devices by their participation in the critical modes
UC-08	Assessment of stability margins under increasing system loading	Proposed	Track stability evolution across multiple operating points
UC-09	Ranking of critical system elements affecting stability	Proposed	Rank elements by their contribution to stability degradation
UC-10	Identification of suitable locations for damping controller installation	Proposed	Separate controller-retuning options from new-device placement
UC-11	Assessment of renewable energy integration impact on system stability	Proposed	Evaluate stability at different renewable penetration levels
UC-12	Automated documentation and reporting of stability assessment results	Proposed	Produce a standardised stability report for stakeholders
UC-13	Assessment of nonlinear system behaviour near critical operating points	Proposed	Characterise the dynamics behind zero eigenvalues
UC-14	Assessment of the region of attraction following system disturbances	Proposed	Quantify security margins against specified disturbances

Figure **??** shows how the five implemented use cases form a single analysis workflow while preserving the distinction between the iMTI-based calculations and the complementary power-flow check.

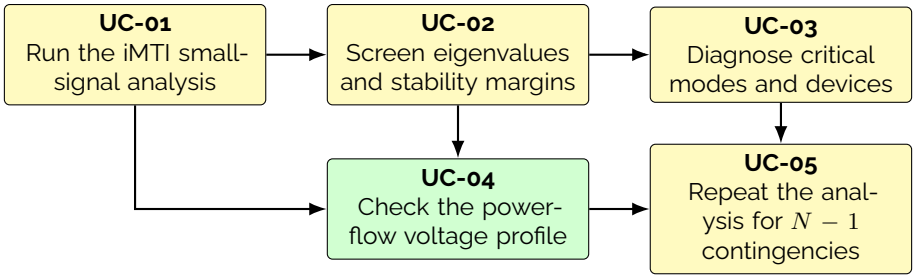


Figure 3.1: Workflow of UC-01 to UC-05. Yellow boxes directly use the iMTI calculation engine; the green box is a complementary power-flow assessment.

Figure **??** groups the proposed cases by the decision that they support. The arrows indicate result dependencies rather than a mandatory execution order.

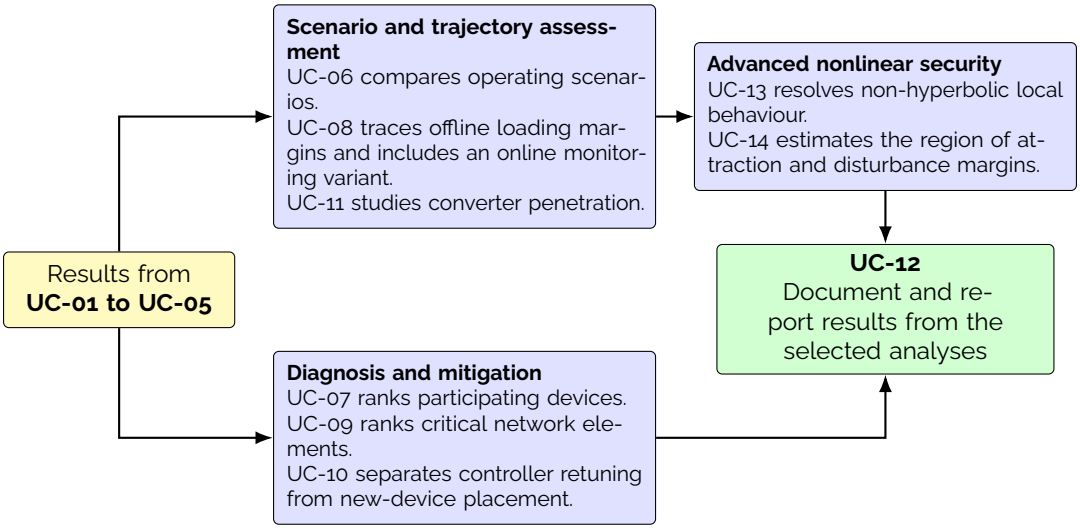


Figure 3.2: Decision-oriented map of UC-06 to UC-14, showing how the proposed analyses extend the implemented Stability Monitor and feed the reporting workflow.

3.2 Implemented use cases

The following five use cases have been prototyped in the TenSyGrid Stability Monitor, a web-based graphical interface that communicates with the native Python TenSyGrid calculation engine (the ported MTI implementation integrated within VeraGrid), running on a dedicated backend server.

3.2.1 UC-01: Assessment of small-signal stability under given operating conditions

Actor. Network operator or planning engineer.

Objective. Load a grid model and compute its small-signal stability properties using the tensor-based multilinear formulation.

Preconditions.

- The TenSyGrid engine backend is running and accessible via a web browser.
- At least one valid grid model is available. It may be supplied as a native `.veragrid` file, through any file format supported by VeraGrid's import layer, through the IPSA adapter from an external tool, or through a configured API endpoint.
- External adapters and API integrations must provide the topology, equipment parameters, operating point, and dynamic-model information required by the selected analysis, and the imported model must pass VeraGrid validation.

Theoretical basis. The iMTI formulation leads to the descriptor system $\mathbf{E}\dot{\mathbf{x}} = \mathbf{A}\mathbf{x}$, from which the generalized eigenvalue problem

$$\lambda \mathbf{E}\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{A}\mathbf{x}$$

is obtained. The solution provides the eigenvalues $\lambda = \sigma \pm j\omega$, where σ governs decay/growth and ω the angular speed ($f = \omega/(2\pi)$). The damping ratio is $\zeta = -\sigma/|\lambda|$. In the tensor-based multilinear framework, the system matrices $\mathbf{S}$ and $\mathbf{\Phi}$ are assembled from the iMTI model, and the descriptor matrices $\mathbf{E}$ and $\mathbf{A}$ are constructed accordingly, from which the eigenpairs used in the subsequent analysis are derived [2].

Possible bottlenecks. No multilinear implementation of a model yet [4]. Scaling issues to be determined.

Main flow.

1. The operator opens the **Run Analysis** tab.
2. The input selector is populated with available grid-model files, IPSA-connected external sources, and configured API endpoints. The operator selects the desired source.
3. The selected input is imported through the corresponding VeraGrid or IPSA adapter, validated, and converted into VeraGrid's internal `MultiCircuit` representation.
4. The operator clicks the **Run Analysis** button.
5. The backend launches the computational script as a subprocess, using the validated internal model and operating point as input.
6. A log output panel displays the analysis progress: power-flow solution, state-matrix assembly, and eigenvalue computation.
7. Upon completion, the result is stored as a `.tensygrid` file in the precomputed-results directory.
8. The status indicator changes from *Running* to *Completed*, and the new result appears in the result list with a colour-coded stability badge (green: stable, yellow: marginal, red: unstable). A configurable numerical tolerance, currently 10^{-6} for the dominant real part, is used to distinguish a marginal result from numerical noise.
9. If the operator needs to abort, the **Stop** button terminates the subprocess gracefully.

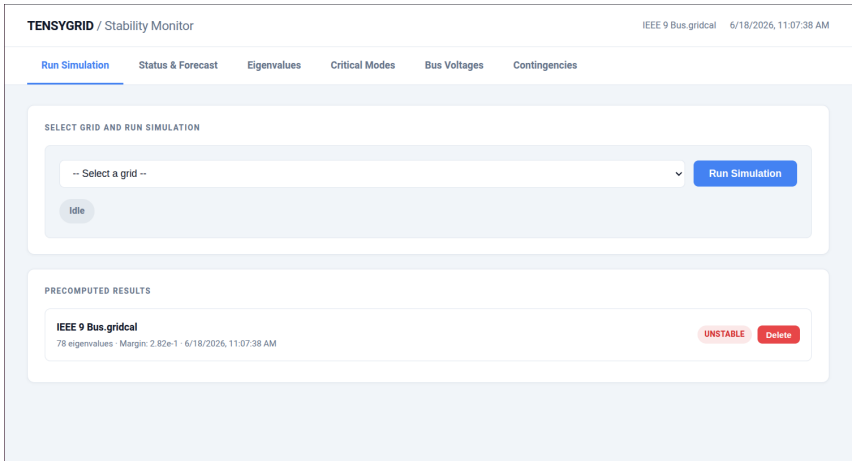


Figure 3.3: UC-01: Assessment of small-signal stability under given operating conditions. The operator selects a grid model, runs the analysis, and monitors progress in the log panel. Upon completion, the result is stored and classified by stability status.

GUI interaction. The **Run Analysis** tab contains an input-source selector, action buttons (Run / Stop), a status badge, an execution log panel, and a list of previously computed results. File-based inputs display the detected format and any conversion warnings. IPSA and API-based sources additionally display connector status and validation results before the analysis starts. Each result item shows the analysis timestamp, the grid name, and the stability classification. A delete button allows removal of obsolete or failed results.

Expected result. A `.tensygrid` file containing the full stability analysis output: eigenvalues, critical modes with participation factors, bus voltages from the power flow, grid topology information, the stability margin, and an operation hash for traceability. This file serves as input for all subsequent use cases (UC-02 to UC-05).

3.2.2 UC-02: Monitoring and screening of power system small-signal stability margins

Actor. Network operator; planning engineer or stability analyst for the detailed spectrum exploration.

Objective. Obtain an immediate, general classification of grid stability together with key

topological and operational metrics, and explore the full eigenvalue distribution in the complex plane to identify clusters, assess damping ratios, and detect modes of concern.

Preconditions. At least one analysis (UC-01) has been completed and its result is loaded.

Theoretical basis. Using UC-01 theoretical basis, we find different regimes in the system stability. We define the dominant eigenvalue λ_1 as the one with the biggest $\Re(\lambda) = \sigma$. For a sufficiently large time t, any other mode becomes negligible relative to the dominant one, since

$$\frac{\mathrm{e}^{\lambda_n t}}{\mathrm{e}^{\lambda_1 t}} = \mathrm{e}^{(\lambda_n - \lambda_1)t} \xrightarrow[t\to\infty]{} 0 \quad \text{for } n \neq 1 \text{ with } \sigma_1 > \sigma_n.$$

Therefore, if $\sigma_1 > 0$, the dominant term blows up to positive infinity, causing a clear instability, whereas $\sigma_1 < 0$ drives all modes to decay.

These two verdicts are conclusive because, when no eigenvalue has $\Re(\lambda) = 0$, the equilibrium is hyperbolic and the Hartman–Grobman theorem guarantees that, in a neighbourhood of the equilibrium, the nonlinear flow is topologically conjugate to its linearisation. The sign of σ therefore reproduces the true local behaviour and not merely a first-order approximation. The theorem also marks the limit of the eigenvalue test: as soon as one mode reaches $\Re(\lambda) = 0$, the equilibrium is non-hyperbolic, the linearisation is no longer topologically equivalent to the nonlinear flow, and the verdict has to come from higher-order terms (UC-13).

The remaining singular case is a mode on the imaginary axis, $\Re(\lambda) = \sigma = 0$, which may be a null eigenvalue ($\omega = 0$) or a purely imaginary conjugate pair ($\lambda = \pm j\omega$, a Hopf-type mode): the argument above rests on the gap $\sigma_1 - \sigma_n > 0$, but here $\sigma_1 = \sigma_n = 0$ makes the exponent $\lambda_n - \lambda_1$ vanish, so the ratio does not tend to zero and the mode is not negligible relative to the dominant one. This equilibrium mode neither decays nor grows (it may oscillate with constant amplitude), i.e. a marginally stable regime that the dashboard classifies as *yellow*.

It is important, however, to distinguish this genuine marginal mode from spurious null eigenvalues that arise purely from the algebraic structure of the generalised eigenproblem $\lambda\mathbf{E}\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{A}\mathbf{x}$: whenever the leading matrix $\mathbf{E}$ (or the pencil $\lambda\mathbf{E} - \mathbf{A}$) is singular, the spectrum contains null eigenvalues that are not associated with any decaying, growing, or oscillating dynamic mode. These structural zeros must be identified and excluded before classifying the system, so that the *yellow* verdict is reserved for actual marginal dynamics.

In addition, each oscillation mode is represented by a conjugate pair of eigenvalues $\lambda = \sigma \pm j\omega$, where σ governs decay-or-growth and ω the angular frequency, so that $f = \omega/(2\pi)$ is the frequency in Hz. In the complex plane, the ratio of σ to $|\lambda|$ gives the damping ratio $\zeta = -\sigma/|\lambda|$, which equals the cosine of the mode's angle with the negative real axis: $\zeta = \cos\theta$. Constant-damping loci therefore appear as straight lines (cones) through the origin, which is precisely what the threshold lines used in the eigenvalue view (e.g. $\zeta = 0$ and $\zeta = 0.05$) represent. Modes close to the imaginary axis $\sigma \approx 0$ fall inside the low-damping cone and are flagged as the ones of concern; the spectrum is inspected to identify which modes concentrate the disturbance. This attribution, however, is the object of UC-03.

Possible bottlenecks. To identify the origin of zero eigenvalues that lead to an inconclusive response.

Main flow.

1. The operator navigates to the **Status** tab.
2. A compact colour-coded badge displays the overall stability classification:
   - **Green** | Stable: all eigenvalues have negative real parts with sufficient damping.
   - **Yellow** | Marginal: the dominant real part lies within the configured numerical tolerance of the imaginary axis (currently 10^{-6}), or some modes exhibit low damping ($\zeta < 0.05$).
   - **Red** | Unstable: at least one eigenvalue has a positive real part.
3. The **Grid Information** card shows the network topology: number of buses, generators, lines, loads, and transformers.
4. The **Key Metrics** card reports the stability margin, the number of critical modes, the total eigenvalue count, and the number of state variables.
5. A compact complex-plane eigenvalue plot provides a visual overview of the spectrum, with a red dashed line marking the stability boundary ($\Re(\lambda) = 0$).
6. The **Stability Assessment** card presents a textual summary with colour-coded recommendations (e.g., "All modes stable", "Caution: low damping detected", or "Warning: positive real parts; the system is unstable").

7. When a detailed exploration is required, the operator navigates to the **Eigenvalues** tab, where a full-page complex-plane scatter plot displays all eigenvalues: horizontal axis = real part σ, vertical axis = imaginary part ω (angular frequency). A red dashed vertical line marks the stability boundary ($\sigma = 0$).

8. The operator can **scroll to zoom** and **drag to pan** across the plot, allowing inspection of dense clusters or outlying modes.

9. Hovering over a point displays a tooltip with the eigenvalue's real part, imaginary part, frequency in Hz, and damping ratio ζ.

10. A **Damping vs. Frequency** scatter plot shows ζ against frequency. Critical threshold lines at $\zeta = 0$ and $\zeta = 0.05$ are drawn for reference.

11. A full **Eigenvalue Table** lists all eigenvalues in tabular form, sortable by real part, damping, or frequency.

12. An **Info** button opens a modal overlay explaining how to interpret eigenvalue plots and damping ratios, targeted at operators who may not be familiar with small-signal analysis.

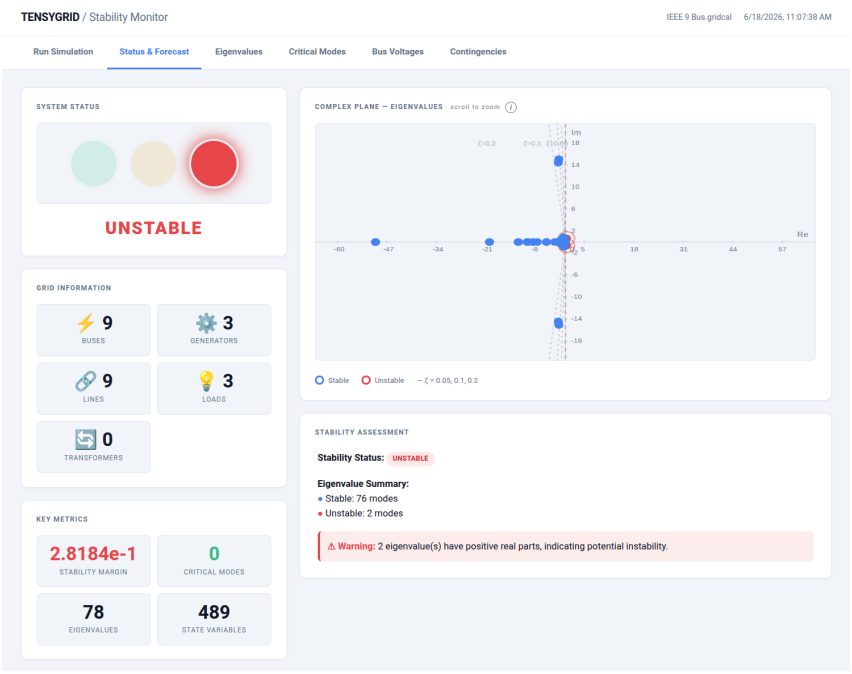


Figure 3.4: UC-02: Status. The operator views the grid's stability status and related information in a consolidated dashboard.

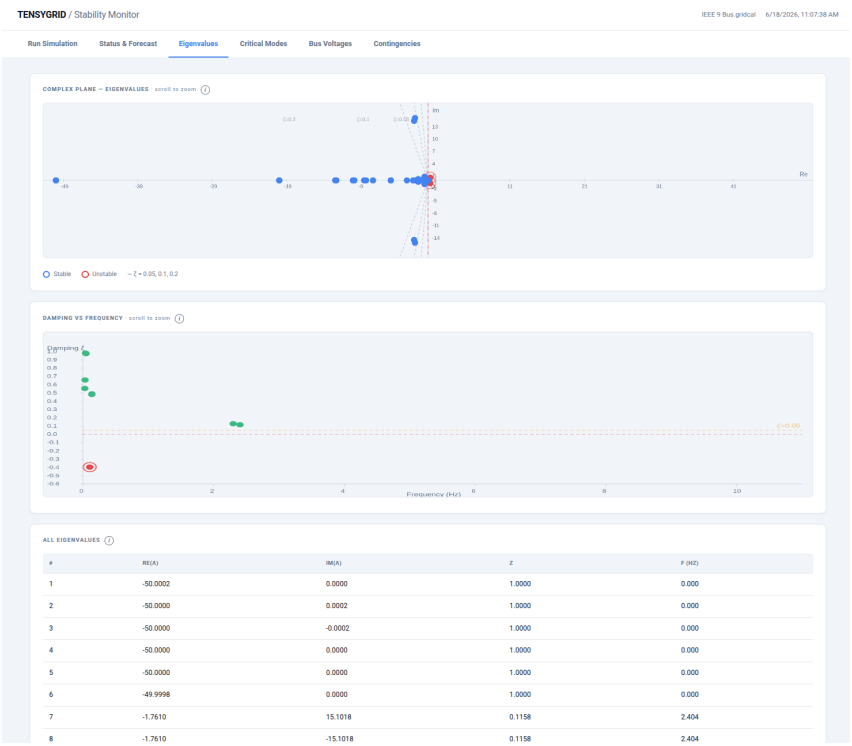


Figure 3.5: UC-02: Eigenvalue analysis. The operator explores the eigenvalue distribution in the complex plane from the Eigenvalues tab.

GUI interaction. The **Status** tab is designed as a control-room dashboard. Colour-coded status badges draw the operator's attention to abnormal conditions without relying on animated traffic-light graphics. All metrics are displayed in large-format cards for quick scanning. The eigenvalue canvas of the **Eigenvalues** tab supports interactive zoom and pan via mouse or touch gestures. The damping plot and table are synchronised with the same data set and update when a different analysis result is loaded.

Expected result. The operator obtains a clear answer to the question *"Is the grid stable"?* together with enough context (topology, metrics) and a detailed understanding of the oscillatory modes (their frequencies, damping levels, and proximity to instability) to decide whether further investigation is needed. If the status is yellow or red, the operator is expected to proceed to UC-03 for detailed diagnosis of the critical modes, and uses this view to evaluate the effectiveness of remedial measures in contingency scenarios (UC-05).

3.2.3 UC-03: Identification and diagnosis of critical oscillatory modes

Actor. Stability engineer or control designer.

Objective. Identify the least-damped oscillation modes and determine which state variables (generators, controls, components) contribute most to each mode.

Preconditions. An analysis (UC-01) has been completed. Eigenvalues have been computed.

Theoretical basis. Each eigenvalue corresponds to an oscillation mode that is a specific combination of perturbations in the state vector. The modal participation factor is defined as

$$p_{ki} = \frac{v_{ki}\,(\mathbf{w}_k^\top \mathbf{E})_i}{\mathbf{w}_k^\top \mathbf{E}\,\mathbf{v}_k},$$

where $\mathbf{v}_k$ and $\mathbf{w}_k$ are the right and left eigenvectors of the pencil $\lambda\mathbf{E}\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{A}\mathbf{x}$ (with $\mathbf{A}\mathbf{v}_k = \lambda_k \mathbf{E}\mathbf{v}_k$, $\mathbf{w}_k^\top \mathbf{A} = \lambda_k \mathbf{w}_k^\top \mathbf{E}$), $v_{ki} = \mathbf{e}_i^\top \mathbf{v}_k$ and $(\mathbf{w}_k^\top \mathbf{E})_i = \mathbf{w}_k^\top \mathbf{E}\,\mathbf{e}_i$ [6]. The GUI displays normalised magnitudes

$$\bar{p}_{ki} = \frac{|p_{ki}|}{\sum_j |p_{kj}|},$$

which sum to 100% per mode. A large $\bar{p}_{ki}$ indicates that the k-th mode is strongly associated with the i-th state, making it a primary candidate for intervention (PSS retuning, FACTS placement).

Possible bottlenecks. In sparse computations of the eigenvalues is difficult to compute their corresponding left and right eigenvectors that are both needed for this UC.

Main flow.

1. The operator navigates to the **Critical Modes** tab.

2. A table lists the modes with the lowest damping ratios, sorted from most to least critical. Each row shows the mode index, real part, imaginary part, frequency, damping ratio, and a stability badge.

3. The operator clicks on a mode row to expand its **participation factors**.

4. An inline bar chart displays the relative participation of each state variable: bars are proportional to the magnitude of the participation factor, and the state variable name is shown alongside.

5. State variables associated with the same physical device (e.g., generator speed $\Delta\omega$, rotor angle $\Delta\delta$, AVR states) are visually grouped.

6. The operator can identify which generators or components dominate the mode, helping to target power system stabiliser (PSS) tuning or FACTS placement at the most effective locations.

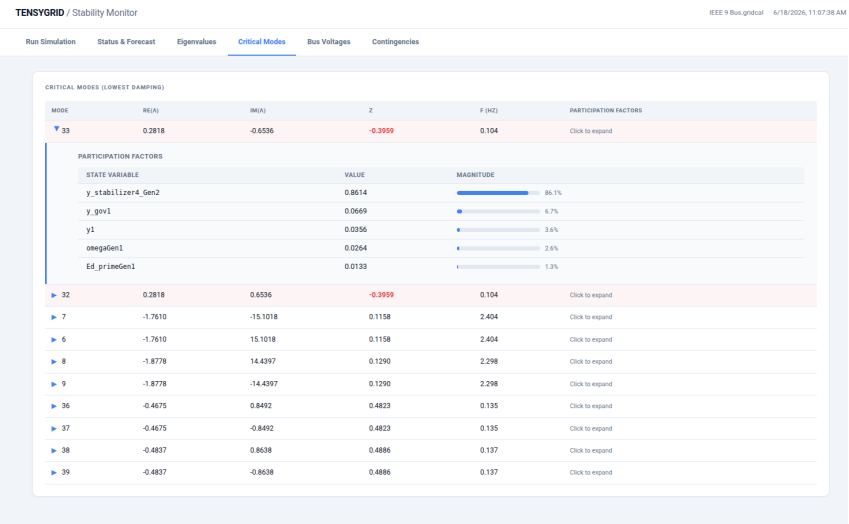


Figure 3.6: UC-03: Critical modes. The operator identifies the least-damped oscillation modes.

GUI interaction. Participation factors are rendered as horizontal bar charts inside expandable table rows. The expansion is animated. The operator can collapse a row and expand another to compare participation profiles across different modes.

Expected result. The operator learns *which physical components are responsible for each critical oscillation*. For example, Mode 3 with $\zeta = 0.02$ at 1.2 Hz may show strong participation from Generator 7's speed and AVR states, indicating that retuning the PSS at that generator would be the most effective mitigation. This directly informs the decisions proposed in next use cases.

3.2.4 UC-04: Assessment of bus voltage profiles and operating limit violations

Actor. Network operator.

Objective. Verify that the voltage magnitudes obtained from the power-flow solution are within acceptable operating limits.

Preconditions. An analysis (UC-01) has been completed and the power-flow solution is available.

Theoretical basis. The power-flow solution provides the steady-state voltage magnitude and angle at each bus of the network. The per-unit voltage magnitude $V_{\mathrm{p.u.}}$ is compared against operational limits: normal operating range (e.g. 0.95–1.05 p.u.) and emergency limits (e.g. 0.90–1.10 p.u.). Buses outside the normal range but within emergency limits are flagged as WARNING; buses beyond emergency limits indicate a severe violation. UC-04 does not perform an iMTI calculation independently. It reuses the operating-point power flow already required by UC-01 and complements the eigenvalue-based assessment, because a system can be small-signal stable while exhibiting unacceptable voltage profiles.

Main flow.

1. The operator navigates to the **Bus Voltages** tab.

2. A table lists every bus in the network with its name (or index) and its voltage magnitude in per-unit (p.u.).

3. Each bus row carries a colour-coded status badge:

   - **OK** (green) | voltage is within the normal operating range (e.g., 0.95–1.05 p.u.).

   - **WARNING** (orange) | voltage is outside the normal range but within emergency limits (e.g., 0.90–1.10 p.u.).

4. Buses with WARNING status are flagged for operator attention. The operator can sort the table by voltage magnitude to quickly locate under-voltage or over-voltage buses.

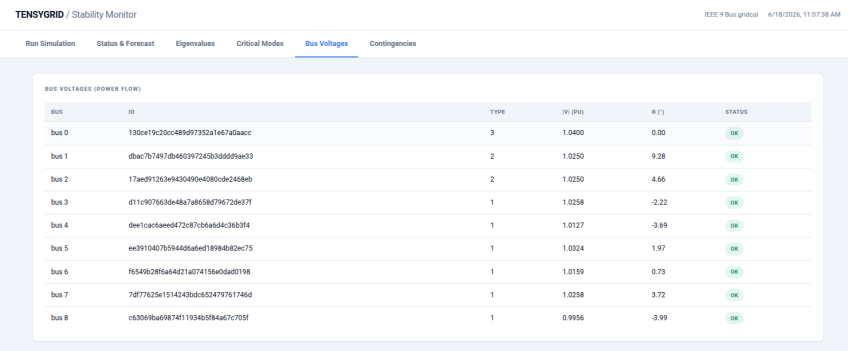


Figure 3.7: UC-04: Bus voltage assessment. The operator validates the voltage profile under the current operating point.

GUI interaction. The bus voltage table is a scrollable table with sortable columns. The OK/WARNING badges use the same colour semantics as the stability traffic lights, maintaining visual consistency across the interface.

Expected result. The operator obtains a quick validation of the voltage profile under the current operating point. Buses with voltage excursions are highlighted, prompting further investigation into reactive power support, tap-changer settings, or load behaviour.

3.2.5 UC-05: Identification of stability risks under $N-1$ contingencies

Actor. Network operator or planning engineer.

Objective. Evaluate the impact of a single-element outage (generator, line, or load) on the small-signal stability of the grid.

Preconditions.

- A base-case analysis (UC-01) has been completed and serves as the pre-contingency reference.
- The grid model contains the values of the element to be removed.

Theoretical basis. For each selected outage, the affected device is changed from `active` to `inactive`. A new power flow determines the post-contingency equilibrium, after

which the iMTI descriptor matrices and eigenvalues are recomputed. The use case is therefore not a conventional $N-1$ power-flow check alone: its TenSyGrid contribution is the comparison of pre- and post-contingency small-signal stability margins and critical modes.

Main flow.

1. The operator navigates to the **Contingencies** tab.

2. The operator selects the contingency type from a dropdown: **Generator**, **Line**, or **Load**.

3. A second dropdown is populated with the available elements of the selected type (e.g., "Generator 0", "Line 3"). The operator selects the specific element to be removed.

4. The operator clicks the **Analyse Contingency** button.

5. The backend launches the contingency analysis script, which removes the selected element from the grid model, re-computes the power flow and the small-signal stability, and returns the post-contingency eigenvalues.

6. The results are displayed as a side-by-side comparison: two complex-plane eigenvalue plots (pre-contingency vs. post-contingency) sharing the same axis scales, plus a summary table listing the contingency type, the element removed, and the change in stability margin.

7. The tool generates **automatic recommendations** based on the observed change:

   - If the system becomes unstable: "Consider installing PSS at the most participating generators or adding a STATCOM/SVC near the affected bus"

   - If damping degrades below the 5% threshold: "Low-damped modes detected; evaluate PSS retuning or FACTS placement"

   - If the stability margin decreases significantly: "Re-dispatch generation or reinforce the affected corridor to recover margin"

8. The operator can repeat the analysis for different elements to explore multiple $N-1$ scenarios. A **Stop** button is available to cancel a running contingency analysis if it takes too long.

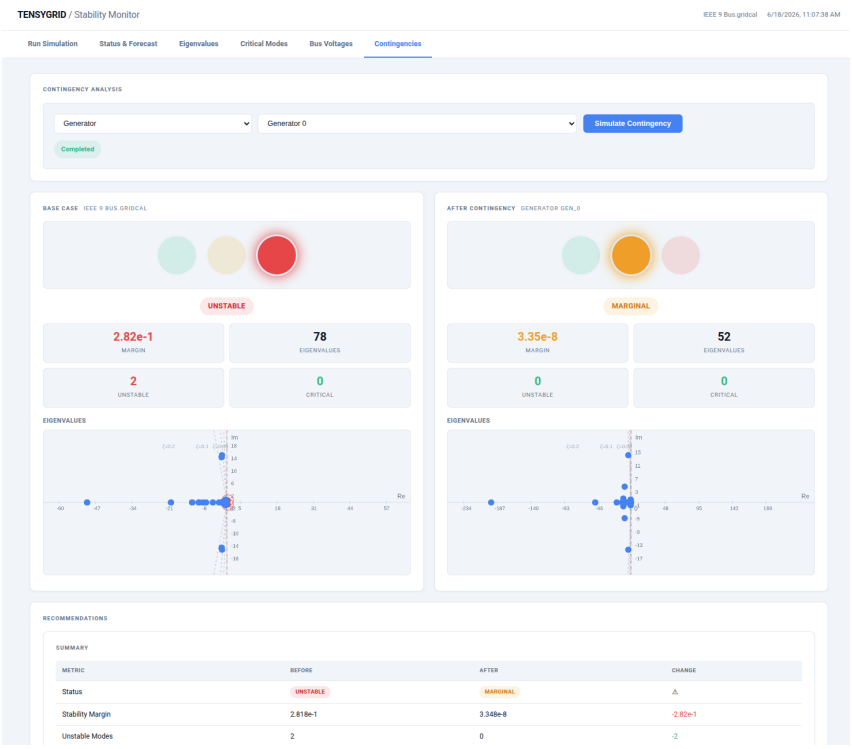


Figure 3.8: UC-05: Contingency analysis. The operator evaluates the impact of different contingencies on system stability.

GUI interaction. The Contingencies tab uses a three-column layout: controls on the left, eigenvalue comparison in the centre, and recommendations on the right. The before/after plots share the same axis scales for direct visual comparison.

Expected result. The operator determines whether the grid remains stable under the selected $N-1$ contingency. If instability or marginal stability is detected, the operator receives targeted, actionable recommendations. This use case supports transmission planning studies and operational security assessment, enabling the operator to identify critical contingencies and plan mitigation measures.

3.3 Proposed use cases

The five use cases described in the previous section correspond to functionalities already prototyped in the Stability Monitor. The following nine use cases are proposed extensions derived from industry interviews, internal technical discussions, or the extension of implemented features. They address workflows that may be relevant to planning and operational studies but remain subject to consortium prioritisation. UC-13 and UC-14 are the most research-oriented proposals and are included so that their assumptions and feasibility can be assessed early.

3.3.1 UC-06: Comparative stability assessment across operating scenarios

Actor. Network operator or planning engineer.

Objective. Compare the stability characteristics of two distinct grid operating points, such as day peak vs. night off-peak, high vs. low renewable generation, or pre- and post-reinforcement scenarios.

Proposed flow. The operator loads two previously computed `.tensygrid` results. The tool performs a differential modal analysis, directly mapping eigenvalues between the two states to track modal shifts. It renders comparative plots and highlights critical structural changes: modes that emerge or disappear, significant drops in damping, and shifts in participation factors that indicate the oscillatory problem has relocated geographically.

Expected value. Operators can assess how seasonal, daily, or structural changes in the network affect stability without manually switching between result sets. This supports both operational planning and infrastructure investment decisions.

3.3.2 UC-07: Identification of devices contributing to stability issues

Actor. Planning engineer.

Objective. Rank the devices of the network by their participation in the critical modes, so that the equipment that most affects the stability of the system can be identified and prioritised.

Preconditions.

- An analysis (UC-01) has been completed and the critical modes have been diagnosed (UC-03).
- The participation factors of the state variables are available in the result file.

Theoretical basis. Each participation factor relates a state variable to a critical mode, so the variables with the largest participation identify the dynamics that dominate that mode. Mapping each state variable onto the device that owns it (generator, AVR, PSS, converter, load) and aggregating the participation factors per device yields a ranking that links every critical eigenvalue to the physical equipment responsible for it. This is the step from the state-level diagnosis of UC-03 to a device-level decision.

Possible bottlenecks. The aggregation is only as good as the metadata that maps states to devices, and several choices must be made explicit:

- **State-to-device mapping.** The result file must retain which device owns each state; otherwise the mapping has to be reconstructed from the model.
- **Aggregation criterion.** Summing the participation factors of all the states of a device favours devices with many states, whereas taking the maximum ignores their combined effect, so the criterion must be configurable.
- **Normalisation and operating point.** Participation factors depend on the mode normalisation and on the operating point, so the ranking may change between scenarios and should be reported with that caveat.
- **Number of critical modes.** A ranking per mode is easy to read, but a global ranking across the critical modes requires weighting them by criticality.

Proposed flow.

1. The operator selects a result and the critical mode to inspect.
2. The tool groups the state variables by owning device and aggregates their participation factors with the selected criterion.
3. A table ranks the devices by aggregated participation, and a bar chart shows their relative weight in the mode.

4. The operator can expand a device to see the state-level participation factors behind its position in the ranking, and switch between the per-mode and the global views.

5. The ranking can be exported as the starting point for the controller-placement analysis of UC-10.

Expected value. The planning engineer obtains a device-level list that translates the modal diagnosis into concrete equipment priorities: which generators, controls, or loads dominate each critical mode and therefore concentrate the mitigation effort. This supports maintenance and retuning plans, the siting of PSS or FACTS devices, and the discussion with asset managers about where stability investment is most effective.

3.3.3 UC-08: Assessment of stability margins under increasing system loading

Actor. Network operator or planning engineer.

Objective. Track the evolution of the stability margin near an operating point, bridging both static and dynamic stability dimensions, to evaluate maximum loadability and proactively anticipate the need for a full Continuation Power-Flow (CPF) study.

Proposed flow. The operator selects a precomputed operating state. By utilizing sensitivity analysis or linearizations of the Jacobian matrix, the tool extrapolates nearby critical points before they are reached in real-world operation. Bridging both static and dynamic stability perspectives, the system simultaneously plots the voltage stability margin (static) and the damping ratio of the most critical electromechanical mode (dynamic) obtained via eigenvalue analysis as a function of the loading parameter. A configurable threshold line indicates when either margin enters a marginal or unstable region, triggering an early warning that a full CPF study or preventive actions are required.

Expected value. Operators gain a unified, comprehensive view of grid vulnerability. They can identify specific windows (e.g., peak hours or seasonal conditions) and determine exactly at which operating thresholds proactive measures, such as generation re-dispatch or topology changes, must be deployed before dynamic oscillations or voltage collapse compromise the system.

Online monitoring variant of UC-08

Actor. Network operator or planning engineer.

Objective. Extend UC-08 to track, in near real time, whether the grid is approaching a critical operating point along a previously analysed trajectory.

Proposed flow. The operator selects a precomputed result of critical paths from UC-08. The tool then checks if the current operating point is approaching any of the critical points identified in the previous use case. The system continuously monitors the stability margin and the damping ratio of the most critical mode, providing real-time feedback on the grid's stability status. If the system detects that the grid is approaching a critical point, it triggers an alert to notify the operator.

Expected value. This optional UC-08 workflow improves situational awareness by comparing the current operating point with precomputed critical paths. It does not imply that the present prototype already provides production-grade real-time integration.

3.3.4 UC-09: Ranking of critical system elements affecting stability

Actor. Network operator, planning engineer, or asset manager.

Objective. Rank generators, lines, and loads by their individual contribution to stability degradation, going beyond single $N-1$ analysis.

Proposed flow. The operator triggers a batch contingency analysis ($N-1$ or $N-2$) across all elements of a selected type. For each contingency, the change in stability margin is recorded. The tool then produces a ranked bar chart or heat map showing which elements cause the largest margin reduction when removed. The operator can click on any element to drill down into the detailed contingency result (as in UC-05).

Expected value. This use case transforms contingency analysis from a *what-if* exploration into a systematic vulnerability assessment. It directly supports critical-asset identification, maintenance prioritisation, and transmission expansion planning.

3.3.5 UC-10: Identification of suitable locations for damping controller installation

Actor. Stability engineer or control designer.

Objective. Provide two clearly separated mitigation pathways for low-damped modes: retuning existing controllers and assessing candidate locations for new damping equipment.

Proposed flow.

1. Building on UC-03 and UC-07, the tool analyses participation factors, residues, modal observability, and controllability across the base operating point and selected contingencies.

2. **Existing-controller retuning path.** The tool identifies generators or converters whose installed PSS or damping controls have high influence on the critical mode. It ranks them as candidates for a subsequent parameter-tuning study, without claiming to calculate the optimal gains or time constants.

3. **New-device placement path.** If existing controls do not provide an adequate mitigation path, the tool ranks candidate buses for new PSS-equipped generation or FACTS devices (STATCOM, SVC, or TCSC). This output is explicitly presented as a capital-investment option requiring a separate techno-economic study.

4. The GUI reports the two rankings in separate panels and labels the evidence, assumptions, and expected qualitative effectiveness of each recommendation.

Expected value. Operators and engineers can distinguish a comparatively low-cost controller-retuning study from the installation of new equipment. The use case translates modal diagnostics into actionable alternatives without implying that the two decisions have the same cost, approval process, or implementation horizon.

3.3.6 UC-11: Assessment of renewable energy integration impact on system stability

Actor. Planning engineer or policy analyst.

Objective. Evaluate the small-signal stability of the grid under different renewable energy

penetration scenarios, assessing how the progressive substitution of synchronous generation by converter-interfaced resources affects system stability.

Preconditions.

- A base-case analysis (UC-01) has been completed and serves as the reference operating point.
- The grid model identifies which machines are synchronous generators and which are converter-interfaced resources, so that the generation mix can be modified without altering the network topology.
- At least one converter-interfaced generator model (e.g. GFL or GFM) is available to replace the synchronous machines that are scaled down.

Theoretical basis. A synchronous generator is described by the swing equation together with the flux and control dynamics of the machine, whereas a complete model of an inverter-based generator adds the converter's inner current and voltage control, the phase-locked loop (or grid-forming virtual impedance), and any outer power or DC-link dynamics. The interface variables exchanged with the network remain the same: the current or power injected at the connection bus. Substituting synchronous machines by converters changes the number and nature of the internal states, so the descriptor matrices $\mathbf{E}$ and $\mathbf{A}$ of the pencil $\lambda\mathbf{E}\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{A}\mathbf{x}$ grow and change shape. Consequently, electromechanical modes of the displaced synchronous machines fade while new converter-driven modes appear. Evaluating the margin and critical modes as a function of penetration exposes this transition.

Possible bottlenecks. Substituting the device equations changes the shape of the $\mathbf{E}$ and $\mathbf{A}$ matrices, so the assembly and pre-processing chain must adapt to a spectrum that mixes synchronous and converter states. Code optimisation may require a complete iteration of the software, and the outcome depends on the accuracy of the converter models, which must be agreed upon before scenarios can be compared.

Proposed flow.

1. The operator selects a base-case result (UC-01) and defines a set of penetration scenarios (e.g. 30%, 50%, 70%, 100% of inverter-based generation), optionally together with a set of critical contingencies.
2. For each scenario, the tool adjusts the generation mix by scaling down synchronous

machines and scaling up converter-interfaced sources while respecting the grid model's structure. It then runs the stability analysis and records the stability margin and critical modes.

3. Results are presented as a curve of stability margin versus renewable penetration, with flags for the penetration level at which the margin crosses the marginal or unstable threshold.

4. Eigenvalue trajectories are plotted to show how specific modes migrate as the penetration level increases, with the newly introduced converter modes highlighted.

5. Critical scenarios can be drilled down via UC-03 (participation factors) and tracked along the progression via UC-08.

Expected value. This use case directly addresses the core TenSyGrid objective of assessing converter-dominated grids. It allows grid planners to determine the maximum renewable hosting capacity under stability constraints and to identify the modes most sensitive to the synchronous-to-converter transition.

3.3.7 UC-12: Automated documentation and reporting of stability assessment results

Actor. Network operator, planning engineer, or regulatory compliance officer.

Objective. Produce a self-contained stability assessment report in a standardised, exportable format (PDF or HTML) suitable for internal documentation, regulatory submission, or stakeholder communication.

Proposed flow. The operator selects one or more analysis results and a report template (e.g., *Standard Stability Assessment*, *Contingency Analysis Summary*, or *Renewable Integration Study*). The tool compiles the following sections in the background: (i) executive summary with stability classification; (ii) grid topology and operating-point description; (iii) eigenvalue plot and critical-mode table; (iv) contingency-analysis results, if available; and (v) recommendations. The report includes the operator's logo, author name, date, and a disclaimer. The operator can preview the report before exporting.

Expected value. Automating report generation reduces the manual effort required to document stability studies, ensures consistency across assessments, and facilitates commu-

nication with non-technical stakeholders (regulators, management, public authorities).

3.3.8 UC-13: Assessment of nonlinear system behaviour near critical operating points

Actor. Stability engineer or control designer.

Objective. Determine the local behaviour of the equilibrium when the linearised model exhibits zero (or near-zero) eigenvalues, by reducing the dynamics onto the centre manifold, so that the tool can distinguish genuine marginal modes from structural zeros and report whether the equilibrium is attracting, repelling, or incipiently bifurcating.

Preconditions.

- An analysis (UC-01) has been completed and its result is loaded.
- The spectrum contains eigenvalues with $\sigma = 0$ (or $|\sigma|$ below a configurable tolerance).
- Structural null eigenvalues arising from a singular pencil $\lambda\mathbf{E} - \mathbf{A}$ have been identified and excluded, as required by UC-02.

Theoretical basis. The Hartman–Grobman theorem guarantees that the linearisation reproduces the local behaviour of the nonlinear system only when the equilibrium is hyperbolic, i.e. when every eigenvalue satisfies $\Re(\lambda) \neq 0$. When an eigenvalue lies on the imaginary axis, either as a real zero (saddle-node) or a purely imaginary conjugate pair (Hopf), the theorem does not apply, the linear model is inconclusive, and the Centre Manifold Theorem (CMT) must be used instead. Before computing the invariant sub-manifolds, an ODE must be obtained from the differential-algebraic (DAE) formulation so that structural zeros caused by a singular $\mathbf{E}$ are discarded. Given the centre subspace $\mathcal{E}^c = \mathrm{span}\{\mathbf{v}_i : \lambda_i = 0\}$ and a complementary stable subspace $\mathcal{E}^s$, the state can be split as $\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{x}_0 + q + p$ (with $q \in \mathcal{E}^c$, $p \in \mathcal{E}^s$). An invariant graph $p = h(q)$, tangent to $\mathcal{E}^c$ at the equilibrium, yields reduced dynamics $\dot{q} = g(q)$ that govern the local behaviour. The first non-vanishing term of g classifies the equilibrium and helps identify the associated bifurcation.

Possible bottlenecks. Deriving an equivalent ODE from the DAE is not as trivial as it may seem. Although one could consider rewriting the algebraic constraints as generalised coordinates, in the spirit of Hamiltonian systems, this is not feasible in the present setting.

An alternative is index reduction by repeated differentiation, which fits the proposed multilinear methodology but whose scaling behaviour on large systems is still unknown. Direct approaches based on Gaussian elimination (e.g. for the structural analysis of the descriptor) could also be explored, but it is not suitable for sparse matrices since it could break that behaviour.

Proposed flow.

1. The operator selects a result containing zero or near-zero eigenvalues and opens the **Centre Manifold** view.

2. The tool separates structural zeros (singular pencil) from genuine equilibrium modes and reports which ones are retained, so that the *yellow* verdict of UC-02 can be justified rather than assumed.

3. For the retained modes, the tool computes the centre manifold reduction and returns the leading normal-form coefficient together with its sign.

4. The equilibrium is classified as asymptotically stable, unstable, or semistable on the centre manifold, and the associated bifurcation type and critical parameter direction are reported.

5. A one-dimensional phase portrait of the reduced flow $\dot{x}_c = g(x_c)$ is plotted, showing the equilibrium and the direction of the trajectories.

6. If the coefficient is close to zero (degenerate case), the tool flags the result as inconclusive and recommends computing higher-order terms or moving the operating point.

Expected value. The operator or engineer resolves the ambiguity left by a null eigenvalue: instead of a generic *yellow* status, the tool states whether the operating point is a benign equilibrium, an incipient bifurcation, or an artefact of the descriptor formulation. This feeds the recommendation logic of UC-05 and clarifies which parameter (load, dispatch, penetration) must be watched before the equilibrium disappears.

3.3.9 UC-14: Assessment of the region of attraction following system disturbances

Actor. Planning engineer or security analyst.

Objective. Estimate the region of the state space from which the system returns to the current operating point after a disturbance, and express it as an interpretable security margin (e.g. maximum tolerable disturbance magnitude or critical clearing time) for a user-selected family of disturbances.

Preconditions.

- An analysis (UC-01) has been completed and the equilibrium, state matrix, and tensor expansion are available.
- The equilibrium is hyperbolic and small-signal stable (all $\sigma < 0$); if some mode has $\sigma > 0$ the basin is empty and the tool reports the instability directly, whereas a mode with $\sigma = 0$ is non-hyperbolic and is redirected to UC-13.
- A family of disturbances has been defined (fault location and clearing time, or a load/generation step at a given bus).

Theoretical basis. Eigenvalue analysis certifies only *local* asymptotic stability: it says that sufficiently small perturbations decay, but not how large a perturbation can be ridden through. For the nonlinear system $\dot{\mathbf{x}} = f(\mathbf{x})$, the boundary of the basin is carried by the stable manifold of the controlling unstable equilibrium (UEP) together with the heteroclinic orbits that link the boundary equilibria. Computing this boundary yields the stability region and an associated security margin. The multilinear tensor representation provides the vector field and its Jacobian directly, so the UEP can be located by Newton's method and its eigenvectors span the local stable and unstable directions. Backward integration then traces the stable manifold, using the variational equations when the manifold is grown in more than one dimension or the boundary is computed by continuation. This route is especially attractive on a low-dimensional reduction (UC-13). It complements, rather than replaces, the exhaustive time-domain EMT/RMS studies recorded in the section on candidate workflows outside the current implementation scope.

Possible bottlenecks. Unlike the DAE reduction of UC-13, the difficulties here are conceptual and geometric, and they define most of the research agenda:

- **Controlling unstable equilibrium.** Identifying the equilibrium on the stability boundary that is closest to the current operating point is a non-convex, multi-start search without global guarantees.

- **Curse of dimensionality and visualisation.** The true basin lives in n dimensions, whereas the GUI can only show a 2D or 3D projection; the projected region is not the actual basin, so the visualisation may mislead the operator.

- **From geometry to operator margin.** Translating the distance (or time) to the stability boundary into a critical clearing time or a disturbance magnitude requires fault-on trajectory information that a small-signal snapshot does not contain.

Proposed flow.

1. The operator selects a result and a disturbance family (e.g. three-phase fault at bus k with variable clearing time, or a step change in load or generation).

2. The tool locates the controlling UEP (Newton) and traces the stable manifold by backward integration of the tensor model, optionally sampling trajectories from the perturbed initial conditions.

3. The basin is rendered on a selectable state plane (e.g. rotor angle versus speed of the most critical machine) with the equilibrium, the estimated boundary, and a set of sample trajectories inside and outside it.

4. The disturbed operating point is overlaid on the same plot, so that the operator sees immediately whether it falls inside or outside the estimated region.

5. The margin is reported as a scalar quantity (critical clearing time, or maximum power step) together with a colour-coded verdict: secure, marginal, or insecure.

6. The result can be compared across operating points (linking to UC-06 and UC-08) and the tool recommends drill-down into UC-05, UC-09, or UC-10 when the margin falls below the configured threshold.

Expected value. The operator obtains a quantitative large-disturbance security margin that complements the small-signal verdict of UC-02: the tool answers not only *"is the equilibrium stable"* but also *"how much can happen before it is lost"*. This supports disturbance-limit setting, protective-relay coordination, and the identification of operating points that are formally stable but practically fragile.

3.4 Candidate workflows outside the current implementation scope

During the use-case identification process, several potential workflows were considered but not included in the current implementation plan. The main reasons were that a workflow requires data or infrastructure that is not available within the project, addresses a different stability phenomenon, or depends on research that must mature before it can be specified as an implementable use case.

- **Full real-time operational integration.** The online variant of UC-08 proposes tracking stability margins at a conceptual level. A production deployment with continuous SCADA or PMU feeds, streaming state estimation, cybersecurity controls, and periodic re-linearisation requires operational infrastructure that is outside the scope of D4.1.

- **Exhaustive time-domain transient-stability simulation.** Large-disturbance stability assessment remains represented by UC-14, consistently with the project proposal. UC-14 computes the stability-region boundary geometrically, using the stable manifold of the controlling unstable equilibrium and the associated heteroclinic orbits obtained from the multilinear representation. Exhaustive EMT or RMS sweeps require additional modelling assumptions, computational infrastructure, and validation metrics. Full time-domain validation of the most severe contingencies is therefore recorded as a possible future extension that would complement, rather than replace, UC-14.

- **Optimal power flow with stability constraints.** Integrating stability constraints directly into an optimal power flow formulation would allow the toolbox to suggest generation re-dispatches or other control actions that guarantee a minimum stability margin. This involves solving a non-convex, constrained optimisation problem and is considered a longer-term research direction.

- **Automated control parameter tuning.** While UC-10 proposes to suggest *where* to place damping controllers, automatically computing the optimal PSS or FACTS parameters (gain, time constants) requires solving a control-design optimisation problem that is beyond the scope of the current deliverable.

- **Multi-area oscillation and inter-area mode analysis.** Identifying and characterising inter-area modes involving geographically separated groups of generators, and computing metrics such as mode shape, observability, and controllability, is partially addressed by UC-03 (participation factors). However, a dedicated inter-area-mode tool with geographical visualisation of mode shapes would require additional development

and is proposed as a candidate for operator feedback.

3.5 Organization

The proposed use cases answer two different kinds of questions: the current system status and its evolution along monitored operating trajectories, and planning studies over longer horizons. Because these questions call for different workflows, the toolbox is organised around a small number of tabs, each grouping the use cases that share a purpose:

- **Run analysis.** UC-01: execute the small-signal stability computation that feeds the rest of the views.
- **Grid information.** UC-04: inspect the steady-state voltage profile of the loaded model.
- **Status and monitoring.** UC-02, UC-03, UC-07, the online variant of UC-08, UC-13 and UC-14: stability verdict and eigenvalue spectrum, critical modes, device-level participation, online trajectory monitoring, and the centre-manifold and region-of-attraction analyses.
- **Planning.** UC-05, UC-06, UC-08, UC-09, UC-10 and UC-11: N-1 contingencies, scenario comparison, trend analysis, critical-element ranking, damping-controller placement, and renewable-penetration assessment.
- **Queue and reports.** UC-12: batch execution and automated report generation.

This grouping is indicative: the exact distribution of the tabs will be refined with the feedback of colleagues and our experience while implementing it.

4 Conclusions

This deliverable has established a structured catalogue of fourteen use cases for the TenSyGrid Toolbox. UC-01 to UC-05 represent five workflows already prototyped in the Stability Monitor: executing a small-signal stability analysis, screening the system status and eigenvalue spectrum, diagnosing critical modes, checking the power-flow voltage profile, and assessing the small-signal impact of $N-1$ contingencies.

UC-06 to UC-14 define nine proposed extensions. They cover comparative scenario assessment, device-level participation analysis, offline and online tracking of stability margins, critical-element ranking, separate guidance for controller retuning and new-device placement, renewable-integration studies, automated reporting, centre-manifold analysis, and region-of-attraction estimation. The proposals combine the objectives of the TenSyGrid project, experience with existing stability tools, lessons from the current prototype, and evidence gathered through industry interviews.

The next step is to prioritise the proposed use cases within the consortium according to technical feasibility, expected industrial value, and their dependence on the iMTI formulation. The selected cases will then be implemented and validated iteratively with industry stakeholders. Workflows that are not part of the current implementation scope remain documented as possible future extensions rather than as commitments of this deliverable.

Bibliography

[1] B. Shneiderman. "The eyes have it: a task by data type taxonomy for information visualizations". In: *Proceedings 1996 IEEE Symposium on Visual Languages*. 1996, pp. 336–343. DOI: 10.1109/VL.1996.545307.

[2] Christoph Kaufmann et al. *Hybrid Implicit Multilinear Model Class and Minimal Format*. TenSyGrid Deliverable D1.1. CETPartnership, Horizon Europe (GA 101069750). Fraunhofer Institute for Wind Energy Systems (IWES), Nov. 2025. URL: https://tensygrid.eu/wp-content/uploads/2025/12/D1.1-Hybrid-Implicit-Multilinear_Final.pdf.

[3] Teresa Wong, Gerwald Lichtenberg, and Christoph Kaufmann. *Improved Multilinearization Algorithm*. TenSyGrid Deliverable D2.1. CETPartnership, Horizon Europe (GA 101069750). Hamburg University of Applied Sciences (HAW Hamburg), Nov. 2025. URL: https://tensygrid.eu/wp-content/uploads/2025/12/D2_1_Improved-Multilinearization-final_HAW.pdf.

[4] Pablo de Juan Vela, Marina Rosés Gilbert, and Maria Sans Esqué. *Multilinear Models for Power-System: Lines, Loads, Converters, and Power-Electronic Devices*. TenSyGrid Deliverable D3.3. CETPartnership, Horizon Europe (GA 101069750). eRoots Analytics, July 2026.

[5] Christoph Kaufmann et al. "Small-Signal Stability Analysis of Power Systems by Implicit Multilinear Models". In: *IEEE access* (2026).

[6] Georgios Tzounas, Ioannis Dassios, and Federico Milano. "Modal Participation Factors of Algebraic Variables". In: *IEEE Transactions on Power Systems* 35.1 (2020), pp. 742–750. DOI: 10.1109/TPWRS.2019.2931965.